

THE MBA WORK-STUDY CLOCK

Country	Term-time work (hours/week)	Post-study work rights
• United Kingdom	20	18 months (Graduate Visa)
• United States	20 off-campus (F-1 visa)	OPT/STEM OPT (1–3 yrs), H-1B lottery
• Canada	24	PGWP (8 months–3 years)
• Australia	48 per two weeks	2–4 years (by level, region, occupation)
• Germany	20	18 months (job search visa), extendable
• France	~20 (964 hours/year)	12–24 months (search, by level)
• Ireland	20	24 months (Stamp 1G)
• Singapore	16	1–2 years (post-study work visa)
• New Zealand	25	1–3 years (by level, region)
• Italy	20 (1,040 hours/year)	6–12 months (job search visa)
• Sweden	Unlimited	Up to 12 months (job seeker)
• Finland	25	1–2 years based on degree
• Dubai (UAE)	Permit-based (varies)	Varies by employer/type

SOURCE OFFICIAL WEBSITES OF MENTIONED COUNTRIES

post-study work pathways. Other Asian destinations, including Dubai and parts of Eastern Europe like Poland and Lithuania, are also emerging as affordable, career-friendly options due to simplified visa processes and growing economic ties with India.

MAKE-OR-BREAK

Talk to students, and you realise that the quiet budget killer is housing. Harsh Pardeshi calls pre-arrival accommodation the biggest stress points: competitive

rentals, requests for in-person viewings from abroad, and a string of upfront costs (bond, transport, insurance) hitting in week one.

In London, the numbers are brutal. The average annual PBSA (Purpose-Built Student Accommodation) rent in 2024-25 is £13,595 (about £295/week), and 14% of PBSA rooms now cost over £20,000 a year, a near tripling since 2022-23, outpacing the maximum maintenance loan, according to a survey conducted by the Higher Education Policy

Institute, UK.

Rohan Mehta, an MBA student at London Business School, is blunt about debt risk: “If you need to mortgage property to do this, don’t.” University Living’s Saurabh Arora adds that in many European cities, only a minority of students secure formal residences, pushing most into private rentals. His advice: treat housing like a second tuition. Book early, budget for multiple deposits, and sync the lease start with visa validity.

What should Indian MBA aspi-